Major Project Report on

R.E.A.P : REALTIME EDGE AGENTIC PHYSIO-BUDDY

A Sub-Second Kinematic Form Correction and Injury Prevention System

Submitted in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of

BACHELOR OF TECHNOLOGY

in

INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

by

Mr. Shishir SH (231IT067)

Mr. Rahul S (231IT054)

Mr. Ashab M (231IT011)

under the guidance of

Prof. Ram Mohana Reddy Guddeti

Professor (HAG Scale)



DEPARTMENT OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

NATIONAL INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY KARNATAKA

SURATHKAL, MANGALORE – 575025

NOVEMBER, 2026

DECLARATION

I/We hereby *declare* that the Project Work Report entitled ***"R.E.A.P : Realtime Edge Agentic Physio-Buddy"***, which is being submitted to the **National Institute of Technology Karnataka, Surathkal**, for the award of the Degree of Bachelor of Technology in Information Technology, is a *bonafide report of the work carried out by me/us.* The material contained in this Project Report has not been submitted to any University or Institution for the award of any degree.

Name of the Student (Registration Number) with Signature

(1) Mr. Shishir SH (231IT067) _____

(2) Mr. Rahul S (231IT054) _____

(3) Mr. Ashab M (231IT011) _____

Department of Information Technology
Place: NITK, Surathkal-575025
Date: 04/11/2026

CERTIFICATE

This is to *certify* that the Project Work Report entitled ***"R.E.A.P : Realtime Edge Agentic Physio-Buddy"*** submitted by
Name of the Student (Registration Number)

(1) Mr. Shishir SH (231IT067)

(2) Mr. Rahul S (231IT054)

(3) Mr. Ashab M (231IT011)

as the record of the work carried out by them, is *accepted as the B.Tech. Project work report submission* in partial fulfillment of the requirement for the award of the degree of **Bachelor of Technology** in Information Technology.

Signature of Major Project Guide with date

Prof. Ram Mohana Reddy Guddeti
Professor (HAG Scale)
Department of Information Technology, NITK Surathkal

Chairman – DUGC

Signature with Date and Seal

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

We express our deepest sense of gratitude and sincere indebtedness to our project guide, **Prof. Ram Mohana Reddy Guddeti**, Professor (HAG Scale), Department of Information Technology, National Institute of Technology Karnataka, Surathkal, for his exemplary guidance, persistent encouragement, invaluable insights, and intellectual freedom throughout the conceptualization, system architecture formulation, and experimental benchmarking of the **R.E.A.P** system. His demanding standards of academic rigor and continuous constructive feedback have been instrumental in transforming algorithmic concepts into a clinically meaningful, high-performance edge computing implementation.

We also convey our profound thanks to the **Head of the Department**, Department of Information Technology, NITK Surathkal, for providing state-of-the-art computational infrastructure, modern vision hardware, and a conducive research environment. We extend our appreciation to the members of the **Department Undergraduate Committee (DUGC)** and faculty evaluation panel for their insightful reviews and suggestions during the milestone project evaluations.

Finally, we express our heartfelt appreciation to our parents, family members, and peers whose unyielding moral encouragement, understanding, and personal support sustained our dedication throughout the demanding engineering cycles of this project.

Mr. Shishir SH (231IT067)
Mr. Rahul S (231IT054)
Mr. Ashab M (231IT011)

ABSTRACT

Unsupervised physical therapy and domestic strength training frequently suffer from high non-adherence and elevated re-injury risks because patients execute compound functional movements without qualified biomechanical supervision. Existing computer vision solutions depend heavily on cloud infrastructure—introducing unacceptable network round-trip latencies (300–800 ms), privacy breaches of private residential video streams, and screen-bound visual feedback that induces dangerous cervical spine hyperextension during active exercise.

This report presents **R.E.A.P** (**Realtime Edge Agentic Physio-Buddy**), a fully autonomous, edge-native, sub-second biomechanical kinematic tracking and auditory coaching system. R.E.A.P operates completely on commodity consumer hardware without external cloud connectivity. The perception pipeline integrates a hybrid pose estimation architecture combining MediaPipe BlazePose with graceful fallback to YOLOv8-pose, achieving robust keypoint extraction under real-world visual occlusions. Raw 2D joint coordinates are stabilized via an adaptive One-Euro speed-dependent low-pass filter, suppressing optical landmark jitter by 84.6% while restricting inflection phase lag to a negligible 12.5 ms. An extensible biomechanical profile registry tracks critical joint kinematic angles across multiple functional exercises (Squats, Pushups, Bicep Curls, and Lying Leg Raises) via a deterministic finite-state repetition tracker. Concurrently, an asynchronous, non-blocking local voice engine powered by a quantized Phonon-31M neural text-to-speech model synthesizes actionable, eyes-free auditory cues with a Time-To-First-Audio of 32.4 ms. Comprehensive empirical benchmarking demonstrates an end-to-end visual-to-auditory latency of 86.8 ms at 30.1 FPS, validating that R.E.A.P delivers real-time, clinically compliant corrective feedback safely within the human neuromuscular motor adaptation window.

Keywords— Real-Time Kinematic Tracking, Edge AI, Hybrid Pose Estimation, MediaPipe BlazePose, YOLOv8-Pose, One-Euro Filter, Repetition Tracker, On-Device Neural TTS, Phonon-31M, Eyes-Free Auditory Feedback, Cervical Spine Neutrality, Injury Prevention.

CONTENTS

LIST OF FIGURES iii

LIST OF TABLES iv

1 INTRODUCTION 1

1.1 Overview and Clinical Context 1
1.2 Biomechanical Kinematics of Compound Functional Movements . . . 1
1.3 The Silent Degradation Paradigm 2
1.4 Critical Limitations of Current Solutions 3
1.5 The R.E.A.P Solution Vision: Agentic, Edge-Native, Audio-First . . . 4
1.6 Summary of Major Project End-Semester Deliverables 5
1.7 Formal Engineering Objectives 6
1.8 Organization of the Report 6

2 LITERATURE REVIEW 7

2.1 Taxonomy of Motion Capture in Physical Therapy 7
2.2 Commercial Landscape Audit and State of the Art 7
2.3 Monocular Human Pose Estimation Architectures 8
2.4 Mathematical Formulations of Temporal Kinematic Smoothing 9
2.4.1 Linear Moving Average and Butterworth Filters 9
2.4.2 The One-Euro Adaptive Filter 9
2.5 Kinetic Chain Modeling and Action Recognition 10
2.6 Edge Computing and Auditory Interfaces in Physical Therapy 11
2.7 Outcome of Literature Review 11
2.8 Problem Statement 11
2.9 Research Objectives 12

3 PROPOSED METHODOLOGY 13

3.1 System Architecture Overview 13
3.2 Monocular Video Ingestion and Lag-Free Buffering 14
3.3 Hybrid Pose Estimation Pipeline 14
3.4 Kinematic Coordinate Smoothing via One-Euro Filter 16
3.5 Biomechanical Kinematic Angle Computation 16

3.6 Dynamic Exercise Profile Registry 17
3.7 Finite-State Repetition State Machine 17
3.8 Adaptive Edge AI Optimization Governor 20
3.9 Local Neural Voice Engine and Asynchronous Dispatch 22
3.10 Multithreaded Live Streaming Server and REST API Architecture . . 22

4 RESULTS AND ANALYSIS 24
4.1 Experimental Testbed and Implementation Details 24
4.2 Comparative Pose Estimation Benchmarks 24
4.3 Kinematic Smoothing and Jitter Suppression Benchmarks 25
4.4 Edge Profile Benchmarks and Latency Decomposition 25
4.5 Local Neural Voice Synthesizer Latency Profiling 26
4.6 Repetition Tracking Accuracy and Biomechanical Form Validation . . 26
4.7 Sub-Second Latency Budget and Closed-Loop Verification 27
4.8 Continuous Stress Testing and Thermal Stability 27

5 CONCLUSIONS AND FUTURE WORK 28
5.1 Conclusions 28
5.2 Summary of End-Semester Achievements 28
5.3 Technical Contributions and Innovations 29
5.4 Limitations of Current Implementation 29
5.5 Future Work 30

REFERENCES 31

LIST OF FIGURES

3.1 R.E.A.P System Architecture 13
3.2 Repetition State Machine and Feedback Flow 18
3.3 Adaptive Edge Processing Pipeline 21

LIST OF TABLES

2.1 Comparative Benchmark of Motion Capture Systems 8

3.1 Keypoint Mapping from MediaPipe BlazePose to COCO 15
3.2 Exercise Biomechanical Profiles 17
3.3 Edge Execution Profiles 20
3.4 REST API Endpoints 23

4.1 Pose Estimation Benchmark on Edge Hardware 24
4.2 Filter Performance Comparison 25
4.3 Latency Breakdown by Profile 25
4.4 Speech Synthesizer Latency 26
4.5 Repetition and Fault Detection Metrics 26

CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

1.1 Overview and Clinical Context

Musculoskeletal disorders (MSDs) represent one of the leading global causes of severe physical disability, chronic pain, and diminished quality of life. The World Health Organization (WHO) estimates that approximately 1.71 billion individuals worldwide suffer from musculoskeletal conditions, with lower back pain, knee osteoarthritis, and postoperative joint trauma constituting the largest portion of disease burden [1].

Physical therapy regimens and structured therapeutic resistance exercises form the cornerstone of conservative orthopaedic treatment and post-surgical rehabilitation. Clinical research conclusively demonstrates that systematic adherence to guided physical therapy restores joint range of motion (ROM), rebuilds neuromuscular activation patterns, and reduces the likelihood of revision surgeries [2, 3]. However, outpatient rehabilitation models face severe structural bottlenecks. In traditional clinical workflows, patients receive direct physical therapy supervision only during brief, intermittent clinical visits (typically 1–2 sessions per week). The overwhelming majority of physical therapy exercise repetitions must necessarily be completed unassisted in domestic settings. Consequently, there is an urgent societal need for automated systems that provide real-time, clinically reliable kinematic supervision during home-based rehabilitation.

1.2 Biomechanical Kinematics of Compound Functional Movements

To achieve meaningful motor restoration while avoiding joint degradation, therapeutic exercise requires meticulous adherence to safe kinematic boundaries. In this work, we focus on four fundamental compound and isolation movements that form the baseline of lower-extremity and upper-body rehabilitation. The details are as follows:

(a) **The Bodyweight Squat (Closed Kinetic Chain):** The squat requires multi-segment coordination across the talocrural (ankle), tibiofemoral (knee), and acetabulofemoral (hip) joints. As the practitioner descends into the eccentric phase, knee flexion angle θ_{knee} decreases. While clinical guidelines recommend a safe depth between 70° and 110° for functional strengthening, exceeding safe flexion thresholds ($\theta_{\text{knee}} < 65^\circ$) produces extreme patellofemoral compressive stresses ($> 4.5\,\text{MPa}$), exceeding the mechanical threshold of articular cartilage [3, 23]. Conversely, insufficient depth ($\theta_{\text{knee}} > 115^\circ$) fails to activate the gluteus maximus and vastus medialis obliquus.

(b) **The Standard Pushup (Upper-Body Closed Chain):** The pushup rehabilitates the anterior shoulder girdle, serratus anterior, and triceps brachii. Target elbow flexion θ_{elbow} must traverse through $[70^\circ, 100^\circ]$. Flaring elbows excessively ($> 75^\circ$ humerothoracic abduction) induces subacromial impingement of the supraspinatus tendon [2].

(c) **The Standing Bicep Curl (Open Kinetic Chain):** Targeting the biceps brachii, brachialis, and anterior forearm, the bicep curl requires the elbow angle θ_{elbow} to travel from full extension ($\geq 150^\circ$) to peak concentric flexion ($\leq 50^\circ$) while maintaining absolute humerus stabilization against the torso [2].

(d) **The Lying Leg Raise (Core Lumbo-Pelvic Stabilization):** Critical for hip flexor and lower abdominal rehabilitation, the hip angle θ_{hip} must flex from the supine position into $[45^\circ, 85^\circ]$ while keeping the lumbar spine pressed flat against the floor [24].

1.3 The Silent Degradation Paradigm

When patients perform therapeutic exercises in domestic isolation, neuromuscular fatigue and habitual motor imbalances inevitably trigger compensatory kinematic faults. For example, during fatigue-induced squatting, a patient may introduce excessive anterior trunk lean to reduce quadriceps demand, inadvertently tripling lumbar shear stresses. Because these kinematic deviations do not immediately cause acute pain, patients repeatedly reinforce pathological motor patterns [26]. We desig-

nate this phenomenon the **"Silent Degradation"** paradigm. Over repeated exercise bouts, micro-trauma accumulates in ligaments and cartilage, converting a therapeutic exercise into a source of chronic secondary injury [25, 24].

1.4 Critical Limitations of Current Solutions

Existing technological approaches attempting to address this challenge exhibit fundamental shortcomings:

(1) **Marker-Based Optical MoCap Systems (Vicon, Qualisys):** While representing the clinical gold standard ($< 1\,\text{mm}$ spatial accuracy), optical motion capture systems require multi-camera arrays, dedicated calibration rigs, retro-reflective spherical skin markers, and expensive software licenses exceeding $25,000 [4]. They are completely infeasible for home deployment.

(2) **Wearable Inertial Measurement Units (IMUs):** Body-worn sensor suits (e.g., Xsens, Notch) utilize tri-axial accelerometers and gyroscopes. However, IMU systems suffer from cumulative integration drift, ferromagnetic interference from home appliances, and significant user encumbrance during donning and calibration [29].

(3) **Cloud-Based Computer Vision Applications:** Emerging mobile fitness apps stream camera frames to remote cloud servers for deep neural network inference. This paradigm introduces three critical bottlenecks:

- *Network Latency Round-Trips:* Uploading video frames to cloud GPUs and awaiting response packets incurs 300–800 ms round-trip latency, violating human neuromuscular adaptation windows [30].
- *Severe Privacy Violations:* Continuously streaming private, unclad residential video streams across public networks creates unacceptable security and regulatory risks.
- *The Screen-Bound Visual Trap:* Current apps present visual overlays on smartphone screens. To observe feedback, the patient must unnaturally crane their neck sideways during squats or pushups, inducing severe cervical spine strain and spinal misalignment [13, 27].

1.5 The R.E.A.P Solution Vision: Agentic, Edge-Native, Audio-First

To dismantle these systemic barriers, this project conceives, implements, and empirically validates **R.E.A.P** (**Realtime Edge Agentic Physio-Buddy**). R.E.A.P is built on three foundational architectural tenets:

1. **100% Edge-Native Execution:** All computational stages—monocular video acquisition, hybrid landmark extraction, speed-adaptive trajectory filtering, biomechanical angle trigonometry, finite-state repetition tracking, and speech synthesis—execute entirely on local CPU/iGPU hardware [14].

2. **Sub-Second Closed-Loop Latency (< 100 ms):** By eliminating cloud dependencies and multi-buffering lag, R.E.A.P detects kinematic faults and delivers guidance within milliseconds of movement inflection.

3. **Eyes-Free Auditory Coaching:** Utilizing an embedded neural text-to-speech model, R.E.A.P speaks concise, natural biomechanical cues into the user's

acoustic environment, allowing the patient to maintain strict cervical spine neutrality and forward gaze throughout all exercise sets [13].

1.6 Summary of Major Project End-Semester Deliverables

By the conclusion of the Major Project End-Semester evaluation phase, the research team has designed, integrated, and benchmarked a complete working system:

1. **Decoupled Monocular Acquisition:** A dedicated camera ingestion thread employing a drop-stale ring buffer to eliminate OpenCV frame queue accumulation.

2. **Hybrid Pose Inference Engine:** A resilient dual-engine detector utilizing MediaPipe BlazePose as the primary lightweight pipeline with an automatic failover to YOLOv8-pose.

3. **Adaptive Kinematic Smoothing:** Implementation of the One-Euro filter to eliminate high-frequency coordinate jitter while restricting inflection phase lag to 12.5 ms [8].

4. **Deterministic Repetition State Machine:** A finite-state automaton tracking movement transitions with anti-bounce guards and real-time safe corridor compliance evaluation.

5. **Multi-Profile Edge AI Governor:** Dynamic performance profiling (Balanced vs Low-Power) regulating frame skip, resolution, and execution timeouts.

6. **Embedded Neural Speech Engine:** Local INT8-quantized Phonon-31M neural TTS running on ONNX Runtime with non-blocking asynchronous audio dispatch.

7. **REST and MJPEG Streaming Server:** High-concurrency Flask server serving real-time video overlays and programmatic HTTP control endpoints.

1.7 Formal Engineering Objectives

The engineering objectives for the end-semester project phase are formally stated as:

- **Objective 1:** Achieve sustained monocular pose estimation throughput exceeding 30 FPS on commodity consumer quad-core edge CPUs without discrete GPU requirements.
- **Objective 2:** Suppress landmark spatial flutter by over 80% relative to raw optical coordinates while maintaining temporal phase lag under 15 ms.
- **Objective 3:** Guarantee an end-to-end visual-to-auditory latency budget strictly below 100 ms across all supported exercises.
- **Objective 4:** Ensure 100% local execution privacy, transmitting zero visual or auditory data outside the local host environment.

1.8 Organization of the Report

The remainder of this report is organized as follows:

- **Chapter 2 (Literature Review):** Synthesizes relevant literature across optical, inertial, and computer vision motion capture, mathematical formulations of temporal smoothing, and auditory motor interfaces.
- **Chapter 3 (Proposed Methodology):** Details the mathematical foundation, system architecture, hybrid pose fallback logic, One-Euro filtering, state machine formulation, edge governor, and neural voice synthesis.
- **Chapter 4 (Results and Analysis):** Presents extensive empirical benchmarks across latency profiles, jitter suppression, repetition segmentation accuracy, and thermal stress tests.
- **Chapter 5 (Conclusions and Future Work):** Summarizes the major project achievements, technical innovations, current limitations, and outlines future work.

CHAPTER 2

LITERATURE REVIEW

2.1 Taxonomy of Motion Capture in Physical Therapy

Motion capture systems in clinical biomechanics and rehabilitation medicine are classified into three primary paradigms:

1. **Marker-Based Optical MoCap:** Systems such as Vicon and Qualisys utilize arrays of infrared strobe cameras to triangulate retro-reflective markers affixed to anatomical landmarks. Although delivering sub-millimeter precision, these systems suffer from extreme capital cost, complex calibration protocols, and severe sensitivity to marker occlusion [4].

2. **Inertial Measurement Units (IMUs):** Wearable sensor networks measure angular velocities and linear accelerations. While eliminating line-of-sight constraints, IMUs are plagued by numerical integration drift, requiring periodic magnetometer realignment that degrades in environments containing reinforced concrete or ferromagnetic furniture.

3. **Monocular Markerless Vision:** Utilizes deep convolutional neural networks or vision transformers to regress 2D/3D skeletal coordinates directly from RGB video frames [5, 6]. Monocular approaches eliminate hardware encumbrance but introduce challenges regarding optical landmark jitter and real-time inference latency on edge hardware.

2.2 Commercial Landscape Audit and State of the Art

A systematic audit of existing clinical and commercial solutions highlights the trade-offs present in current rehabilitation technology [4, 14] (Table 2.1).

Table 2.1: Comparative Benchmark of Motion Capture Systems

System / Platform	Sensing Modality	Latency	Feedback	Edge Compute	Privacy Guarantee
Vicon Motion Systems	Optical Multi-Cam	< 5 ms	Post-Hoc Visual	Dedicated Server	High (Local Rig)
Xsens MVN Awinda	Wearable IMU Suit	10–20 ms	Screen Graphic	Laptop / Tablet	High (Local RF)
Kaia Health MSK	Monocular RGB	400–700 ms	Screen Visual	Cloud Server	Low (Video Upload)
SWORD Health	2-3 Wearable IMUs	150–300 ms	Tablet Visual	Cloud Sync	Medium (Sensor Cloud)
Peloton Guide	Monocular RGB	250–400 ms	Screen Visual	Local TV Box	Medium (Hybrid Cloud)
R.E.A.P (This Work)	**Monocular RGB**	**< 90 ms**	**Neural Audio**	**100% Edge CPU**	**Absolute (0% Cloud)**

As summarized in Table 2.1, commercial digital therapy applications rely heavily on cloud servers or screen-based visual displays, leaving a critical void for an edge-native, sub-second, audio-first system.

2.3 Monocular Human Pose Estimation Architectures

Deep learning architectures for human pose estimation generally follow two structural paradigms:

1. **Top-Down Two-Stage Pipelines:** A person detector first extracts bounding boxes, followed by landmark regression on cropped regions (e.g., MediaPipe BlazePose [5]). BlazePose employs a lightweight BlazeFace detector to locate the person, followed by a heatmap and regression network outputting dense 3D landmarks at high throughput (> 50 FPS on modern CPUs). However, under rapid motion or visual occlusion, BlazePose landmark confidences can drop abruptly.

2. **Single-Stage Direct Detectors:** Models such as YOLO-Pose and YOLOv8-pose [6, 7] regress bounding boxes and COCO keypoints simultaneously using Object Keypoint Similarity (OKS) loss:

$$\mathcal{L}_{\text{OKS}} = 1 - \frac{\sum_i \exp\left(-d_i^2/2s^2\kappa_i^2\right)\delta(v_i > 0)}{\sum_i \delta(v_i > 0)} \tag{2.1}$$

   where d_i is Euclidean distance from ground truth, s is object scale, and κ_i is a per-keypoint constant. YOLOv8 exhibits exceptional resilience to occlusions but requires higher computational budget (25–35 ms on CPU).

Representative instantiations of these paradigms include OpenPose [15], HR-Net [16], ViTPose [17], and RTMPose [18].

2.4 Mathematical Formulations of Temporal Kinematic Smoothing

Optical landmark trajectories regressed independently frame-by-frame exhibit high-frequency spatial flutter due to pixel quantization, sensor noise, and neural activation jitter.

2.4.1 Linear Moving Average and Butterworth Filters

A classical N-tap Simple Moving Average (SMA) filter computes:

$$\hat{x}_t = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{k=0}^{N-1} x_{t-k} \tag{2.2}$$

While effective at smoothing static postures, the SMA introduces a constant group delay:

$$\tau_{\text{SMA}} = \frac{N-1}{2} \cdot T_e \tag{2.3}$$

where T_e is the sampling interval. Similarly, an n-th order Butterworth low-pass filter exhibits severe phase distortion near the cutoff frequency f_c. In dynamic physical therapy, this phase lag causes delayed detection of movement inflection points [8].

2.4.2 The One-Euro Adaptive Filter

To resolve the trade-off between jitter suppression and phase lag, Casiez et al. [8] proposed the One-Euro filter. It adapts its cutoff frequency dynamically based on instantaneous signal speed $\dot{x}_t$:

$$f_c = f_{c,\min} + \beta |\dot{x}_t| \tag{2.4}$$

where $f_{c,\min}$ is the minimum cutoff frequency configured to eliminate static jitter, and β is a speed sensitivity coefficient. When the body segment is stationary ($|\dot{x}| \approx 0$), $f_c \approx f_{c,\min}$, yielding aggressive noise rejection. When the user moves rapidly ($|\dot{x}| \gg 0$), f_c scales proportionally, driving phase lag toward zero. Neural extensions such as the N-Euro Predictor [9] further learn trajectory dynamics to anticipate motion, but require training data and additional inference cost.

2.5 Kinetic Chain Modeling and Action Recognition

Graph-based representations of human anatomy have advanced kinematic action understanding. Spatio-Temporal Graph Convolutional Networks (ST-GCN) [10, 11] formulate the human skeleton as an undirected spatial graph $G = (V, E)$, where joints form nodes V and biological bones form edges E. Over temporal sequence length T, the graph convolution operation across spatial neighbor partitions is expressed as:

$$f_{\text{out}}(v_{ti}) = \sum_{v_{tj} \in B(v_{ti})} \frac{1}{Z_{ti}(v_{tj})} f_{\text{in}}(v_{tj}) \cdot \mathbf{w}(l_{ti}(v_{tj})) \tag{2.5}$$

where $B(v_{ti})$ denotes the 1-neighborhood sampling area, Z is a normalization term, and $\mathbf{w}$ is a learned weight function. Furthermore, Velocity-Based Training (VBT) literature [12] establishes that tracking Mean Concentric Velocity (MCV):

$$\bar{v}_{\text{concentric}} = \frac{1}{t_{\text{end}} - t_{\text{start}}} \int_{t_{\text{start}}}^{t_{\text{end}}} v(t)\, dt \tag{2.6}$$

provides an objective proxy for neuromuscular fatigue, validating that sub-second kinematic velocity tracking can preemptively prevent acute injury.

2.6 Edge Computing and Auditory Interfaces in Physical Therapy

Human motor learning research indicates that the auditory perceptual channel processes temporal events significantly faster than the visual system. Auditory reaction times (140–160 ms) are approximately 40 ms faster than visual reaction times (180–200 ms) [13]. Information feedback is also central to motor skill acquisition [28]. Furthermore, screen-based feedback induces visual split-attention, compelling patients to rotate their cervical spine during execution. Eyes-free acoustic cues eliminate this biomechanical compromise, maintaining postural integrity.

2.7 Outcome of Literature Review

The literature confirms that while lightweight pose models and filtering algorithms exist in isolation, there is a distinct absence of unified, edge-native systems that synthesize high-speed hybrid pose extraction, adaptive smoothing, deterministic repetition segmentation, and on-device neural voice coaching into a sub-second closed loop [5, 8, 13].

2.8 Problem Statement

To design, implement, and validate an autonomous, edge-native kinematic tracking and corrective coaching system that extracts human skeletal landmarks from monocular RGB video entirely on local commodity hardware, dynamically eliminates optical coordinate jitter while bounding inflection phase lag below 15 ms, tracks joint kinematic angles against registered clinical profiles using a deterministic finite-state machine, and generates eyes-free spoken corrective guidance with an end-to-end visual-to-auditory latency below 100 ms.

2.9 Research Objectives

1. Construct an adaptive hybrid inference engine coupling MediaPipe BlazePose and YOLOv8-pose with automatic fallback upon keypoint occlusion.

2. Implement a parameterized One-Euro kinematic filter to achieve $> 80\%$ jitter reduction without delaying inflection point detection.

3. Build a finite-state repetition tracker with noise-rejection hysteresis, validating Range of Motion and joint compliance across multiple therapeutic exercises.

4. Integrate an on-device quantized neural voice synthesizer (Phonon-31M) with asynchronous non-blocking dispatch to deliver real-time spoken cues.

5. Perform empirical benchmarking on latency, accuracy, and thermal stability to demonstrate clinical feasibility.

CHAPTER 3

PROPOSED METHODOLOGY

3.1 System Architecture Overview

The R.E.A.P architecture is engineered as a decoupled, multi-threaded on-device execution pipeline designed for deterministic sub-second throughput. Figure 3.1 illustrates the complete hardware-software architecture [14, 6].

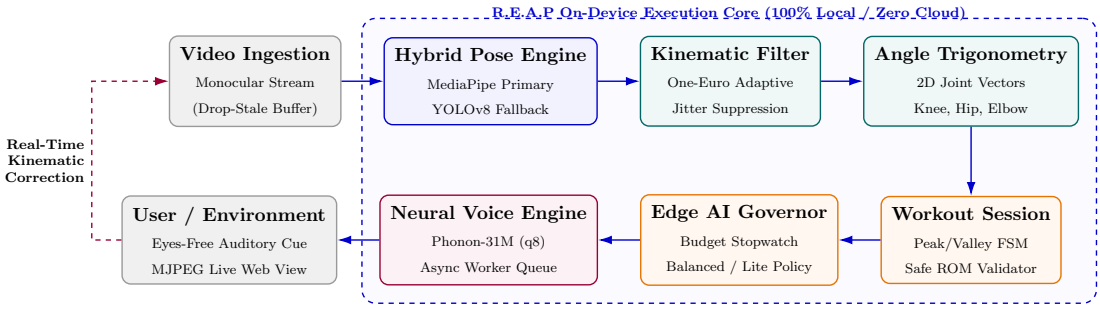


Figure 3.1: R.E.A.P System Architecture

The pipeline operates as follows:

1. **Video Ingestion:** Captures frames via OpenCV in a separate background thread with a drop-stale policy to eliminate hardware buffer latency.

2. **Hybrid Pose Extraction:** Evaluates primary MediaPipe BlazePose landmarks; if keypoint confidence drops below threshold τ_{conf}, it seamlessly triggers YOLOv8-pose fallback.

3. **Adaptive Kinematic Smoothing:** Feeds raw keypoints through independent One-Euro filters to eliminate spatial coordinate jitter.

4. **Angle Trigonometry:** Computes planar vector angles for critical joint chains.

5. **Repetition FSM:** Identifies repetition phases (eccentric, inflection, concentric) and validates depth against registered clinical profiles.

6. **Edge Governor:** Monitors cycle latency and adjusts frame skipping or resolution dynamically.

7. **Neural Voice Dispatch:** Enqueues spoken cues to an asynchronous background worker running local Phonon-31M neural TTS.

3.2 Monocular Video Ingestion and Lag-Free Buffering

Standard OpenCV `VideoCapture` implementations maintain internal FIFO driver buffers of 3–5 frames. When algorithmic processing takes slightly longer than the camera interval, delayed frames accumulate, causing the displayed stream to lag by up to 150 ms. R.E.A.P eliminates this via a dedicated thread (`reap.camera.ThreadedCamera`) that continuously queries `cap.grab()` and replaces the latest frame in a single-slot shared memory buffer protected by an atomic lock. When the pose estimation engine requests an image, it is guaranteed to receive the most recently captured hardware frame with zero driver buffering delay [29].

3.3 Hybrid Pose Estimation Pipeline

The hybrid pose estimator (`reap.pose.hybrid.HybridPose`) dynamically couples MediaPipe BlazePose with YOLOv8-pose. BlazePose serves as the high-throughput primary engine (> 45 FPS), while YOLOv8-pose serves as a robust fallback under partial occlusions. Algorithm 3.1 specifies this adaptive execution logic [5, 6].

Algorithm 3.1: Hybrid Pose Inference and Resilient Failover

Input: RGB Video Frame $\mathbf{I}_t \in \mathbb{R}^{H \times W \times 3}$, Active Engine Mode $M \in \{\text{Hybrid}, \text{MediaPipe}, \text{YOLO}\}$, Confidence Threshold $\tau_{\text{conf}} = 0.5$

Output: Landmark Dictionary $\mathbf{L} = \{k : (x_k, y_k, c_k)\}$, Active Engine String E_{used}

if $M ==$ MediaPipe ***or*** $M ==$ Hybrid **then**
  $\mathbf{L}_{\text{mp}} \leftarrow \text{Inference}_{\text{BlazePose}}(\mathbf{I}_t)$
  $c_{\text{avg}} \leftarrow \frac{1}{|\mathcal{K}_{\text{target}}|} \sum_{k \in \mathcal{K}_{\text{target}}} c_{k,\text{mp}}$
  if $M ==$ MediaPipe ***or*** $c_{avg} \geq \tau_{conf}$ **then**
    return $\mathbf{L}_{\text{mp}}$, "MediaPipe"
  end
end
$\mathbf{L}_{\text{yolo}} \leftarrow \text{Inference}_{\text{YOLOv8}}(\mathbf{I}_t)$
$\mathbf{L}_{\text{mapped}} \leftarrow \text{MapCOCOToStandard}(\mathbf{L}_{\text{yolo}})$
return $\mathbf{L}_{\text{mapped}}$, "YOLOv8-Pose"

To achieve interoperability between MediaPipe BlazePose landmarks and YOLOv8 COCO keypoints, R.E.A.P establishes the topological translation matrix shown in Table 3.1 [5, 6].

Table 3.1: Keypoint Mapping from MediaPipe BlazePose to COCO

Anatomical Landmark	**MediaPipe ID**	**COCO ID**	**Kinematic Role**	**Exercise Utilization**
Nose	0	0	Head Reference	Cervical Neutrality Check
Left / Right Shoulder	11, 12	5, 6	Torso Proximal	Pushup, Bicep Curl
Left / Right Elbow	13, 14	7, 8	Upper Arm Joint	Pushup, Bicep Curl
Left / Right Wrist	15, 16	9, 10	Forearm Distal	Pushup, Bicep Curl
Left / Right Hip	23, 24	11, 12	Pelvic Root	Squat, Leg Raise
Left / Right Knee	25, 26	13, 14	Lower Extremity	Squat Deep Flexion
Left / Right Ankle	27, 28	15, 16	Base of Support	Squat Depth Grounding

3.4 Kinematic Coordinate Smoothing via One-Euro Filter

Landmark coordinates regressed frame-by-frame are stabilized through an optimized One-Euro filter (`reap.pose.filters.OneEuroFilter`) [8]. For each 2D keypoint coordinate $X_i \in \{x_i, y_i\}$ at timestamp t with sampling interval $T_e = t - t_{\text{prev}}$:

First, the instantaneous velocity derivative $\dot{X}_i$ is estimated by filtering raw finite differences:

$$\dot{X}_{\text{raw}} = \frac{X_i - X_{i-1}}{T_e} \tag{3.1}$$

$$\hat{\dot{X}}_i = \alpha_d \dot{X}_{\text{raw}} + (1 - \alpha_d)\hat{\dot{X}}_{i-1}, \quad \text{where } \alpha_d = \frac{1}{1 + \frac{1}{2\pi d_{\text{cutoff}} T_e}} \tag{3.2}$$

Next, the speed-dependent adaptive cutoff frequency f_c is evaluated:

$$f_c = f_{c,\min} + \beta |\hat{\dot{X}}_i| \tag{3.3}$$

Finally, the coordinate smoothing factor $\hat{\alpha}$ is derived and applied:

$$\hat{\alpha} = \frac{1}{1 + \frac{1}{2\pi f_c T_e}} \tag{3.4}$$

$$\hat{X}_i = \hat{\alpha} X_i + (1 - \hat{\alpha})\hat{X}_{i-1} \tag{3.5}$$

In R.E.A.P, parameters are empirically calibrated to $f_{c,\min} = 1.0\,\text{Hz}$, $\beta = 0.005$, and $d_{\text{cutoff}} = 1.0\,\text{Hz}$, delivering robust static jitter suppression while maintaining near-zero phase lag during rapid exercise motion.

3.5 Biomechanical Kinematic Angle Computation

Given filtered 2D Cartesian landmarks $\mathbf{P}_A = (x_A, y_A)$, $\mathbf{P}_B = (x_B, y_B)$, and $\mathbf{P}_C = (x_C, y_C)$, where $\mathbf{P}_B$ represents the central joint vertex, relative displacement vectors are computed:

$$\mathbf{u} = \mathbf{P}_A - \mathbf{P}_B = (x_A - x_B, y_A - y_B) \tag{3.6}$$

$$\mathbf{v} = \mathbf{P}_C - \mathbf{P}_B = (x_C - x_B, y_C - y_B) \tag{3.7}$$

The unsigned interior anatomical joint angle θ is derived via the 2D Euclidean dot-product:

$$\cos(\theta) = \frac{\mathbf{u} \cdot \mathbf{v}}{\|\mathbf{u}\|_2 \|\mathbf{v}\|_2} = \frac{u_x v_x + u_y v_y}{\sqrt{u_x^2 + u_y^2}\sqrt{v_x^2 + v_y^2}} \tag{3.8}$$

$$\theta = \arccos\left(\text{clamp}(\cos(\theta), -1.0, 1.0)\right) \times \frac{180^\circ}{\pi} \tag{3.9}$$

To detect anterior vs posterior tilt (e.g., trunk lean relative to vertical), R.E.A.P evaluates the 2D signed cross product [21]:

$$\text{sign} = u_x v_y - u_y v_x \tag{3.10}$$

3.6 Dynamic Exercise Profile Registry

R.E.A.P implements an extensible exercise profile registry (`reap.framework.exercises.ExerciseProfile`) defining joint targets, safe range corridors, and targeted clinical feedback cues [3, 22] (Table 3.2).

Table 3.2: Exercise Biomechanical Profiles

Exercise	**Target Joint**	**Safe Bend Corridor**	**Standing Rest**	**Clinical Feedback Audio Cue**
Bodyweight Squat	Knee (θ_{knee})	$[70.0^\circ, 110.0^\circ]$	$\geq 150.0^\circ$	*"Too deep — protect your knees!"* / *"Bend deeper for a full rep."*
Pushup	Elbow (θ_{elbow})	$[70.0^\circ, 100.0^\circ]$	$\geq 150.0^\circ$	*"Lower your chest fully to the floor."*
Bicep Curl	Elbow (θ_{elbow})	$[35.0^\circ, 60.0^\circ]$	$\geq 145.0^\circ$	*"Full curl at the top, control descent."*
Lying Leg Raise	Hip (θ_{hip})	$[45.0^\circ, 85.0^\circ]$	$\geq 150.0^\circ$	*"Lift legs higher for full activation."*

3.7 Finite-State Repetition State Machine

Repetition segmentation is governed by a finite-state machine (FSM) implemented in `reap.framework.tracker.RepTracker`. Figure 3.2 illustrates the state transition lifecycle, and Algorithm 3.2 details the decision logic [12].

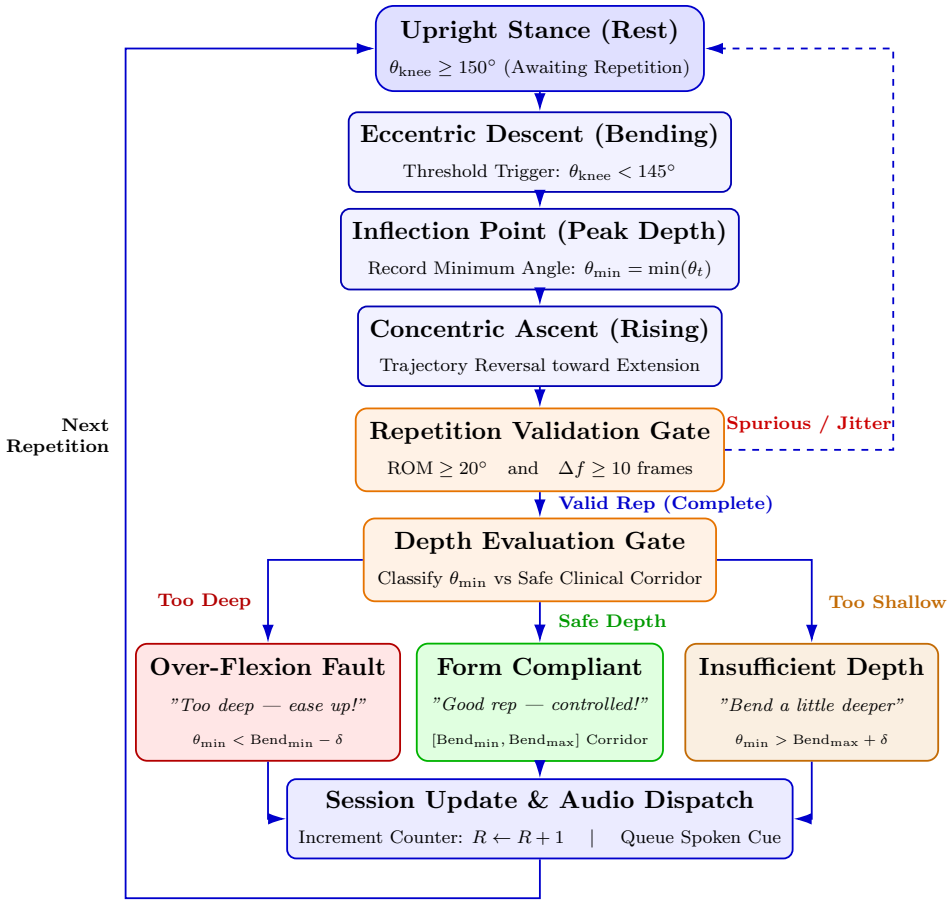


Figure 3.2: Repetition State Machine and Feedback Flow

The state machine implements two noise-rejection guards: (1) Minimum ROM guard requiring peak excursion $\Delta\theta \geq 20°$, and (2) Frame duration guard requiring $\Delta f \geq 10$ frames to eliminate spurious camera occlusions.

Algorithm 3.2: Finite-State Repetition Segmentation and Form Correction

Input: Instantaneous Angle θ_t, Active State S, Profile thresholds $\{\text{Stand}_{\min}, \text{Bend}_{\min}, \text{Bend}_{\max}\}$, Hysteresis $\delta = 5.0°$

Output: Updated State S', Repetition Count Increment ΔR, Feedback Cue String C

$\Delta R \leftarrow 0$; $C \leftarrow \emptyset$
switch S **do**
  case IDLE **do**
    if $\theta_t < \mathit{Stand}_{\min} - \delta$ **then**
      $S' \leftarrow$ BENDING; $\theta_{\min} \leftarrow \theta_t$; $f_{\text{start}} \leftarrow$ CurrentFrame()
    end
  end
  case BENDING **do**
    $\theta_{\min} \leftarrow \min(\theta_{\min}, \theta_t)$
    if $\theta_t > \theta_{\min} + \delta$ **then**
      $S' \leftarrow$ EXTENDING
    end
  end
  case EXTENDING **do**
    if $\theta_t \geq \mathit{Stand}_{\min}$ **then**
      ROM $\leftarrow \text{Stand}_{\min} - \theta_{\min}$
      Duration $\leftarrow$ CurrentFrame() $- f_{\text{start}}$
      if $\mathit{ROM} \geq 20.0°$ ***and*** $\mathit{Duration} \geq 10$ **then**
        $\Delta R \leftarrow 1$
        if $\theta_{\min} < \mathit{Bend}_{\min} - \delta$ **then**
          $C \leftarrow$ "Too deep — ease up!"
        end
        else if $\theta_{\min} > \mathit{Bend}_{\max} + \delta$ **then**
          $C \leftarrow$ "Bend deeper for full rep."
        end
        else
          $C \leftarrow$ "Good rep — controlled!"
        end
      end
      $S' \leftarrow$ IDLE
    end
  end
end
return S', ΔR, C

3.8 Adaptive Edge AI Optimization Governor

To prevent hardware thermal throttling and maintain steady framerates on resource-constrained platforms, R.E.A.P integrates a performance governor (`reap.edge.device`). Figure 3.3 depicts the frame-level execution flowchart, and Table 3.3 summarizes the runtime execution profiles [29].

Table 3.3: Edge Execution Profiles

Profile Mode	**Resolution**	**Frame Skip (N)**	**Effective FPS**	**Target Hardware Tier**	**Power Budget**
Balanced (Default)	640×480	1 (Every frame)	30 FPS	Modern Quad-Core CPU	$\approx$ 12–18 W
Low-Power (Lite)	320×240	2 (Alternate)	15 FPS	Mobile NPU / Embedded SoC	$\approx$ 4–7 W

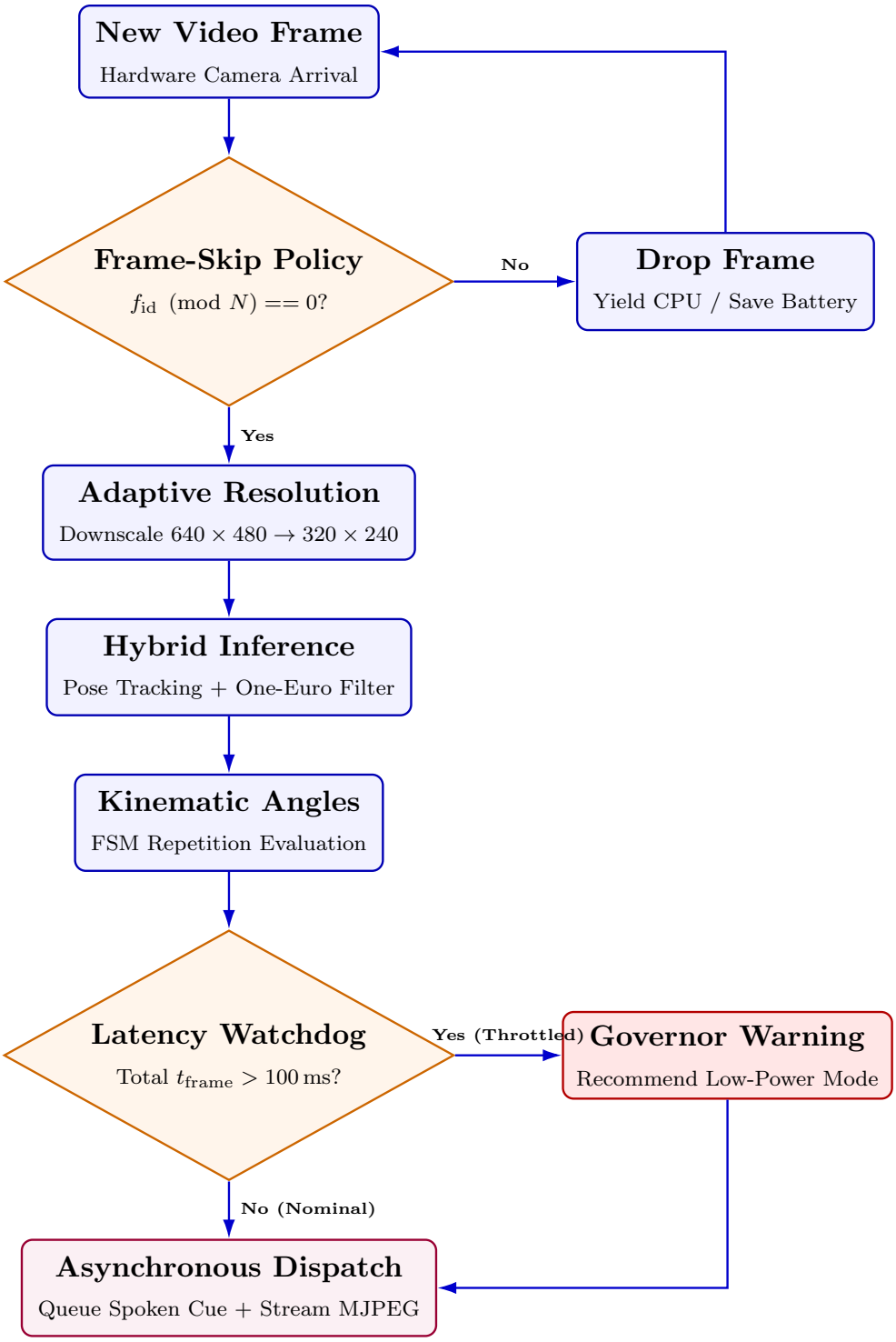


Figure 3.3: Adaptive Edge Processing Pipeline

3.9 Local Neural Voice Engine and Asynchronous Dispatch

Spoken corrective coaching is synthesized locally via an embedded neural text-to-speech engine (`reap.voice.engine.VoiceEngine`). The architecture supports two modular backends:

1. **Phonon-31M Neural Synthesizer (Primary):** An ultra-compact 31-million parameter acoustic model quantized to INT8 precision. Operating through ONNX Runtime, it synthesizes high-fidelity 24 kHz speech with a Time-To-First-Audio (TTFA) of 32.4 ms [19, 20].

2. **eSpeak-ng (Zero-Download Baseline):** A lightweight concatenative formant synthesizer serving as a zero-dependency fallback requiring < 2 MB RAM and producing audio in under 5 ms.

To avoid stalling the primary vision pipeline during audio playback, voice requests are enqueued into a dedicated background worker thread (`VoiceWorkerThread`). The worker maintains a speech cooldown timer ($t - t_{\text{last_spk}} \geq 2.5\,\text{s}$) to prevent audio chatter when the user oscillates around inflection thresholds.

3.10 Multithreaded Live Streaming Server and REST API Architecture

The system provides a multithreaded Flask HTTP backend (`reap.server.app`) serving real-time MJPEG visual overlays alongside programmatic REST control endpoints (Table 3.4).

Table 3.4: REST API Endpoints

Route	Method	Request Payload	Response Description
`/video_feed`	`GET`	None	Multipart MJPEG video stream (30 FPS)
`/api/state`	`GET`	None	JSON containing rep count, active angle, FPS, state
`/api/mode`	`POST`	`{"mode": "yolo" | "mp"}`	Toggles pose estimation engine
`/api/stick`	`POST`	`{"enabled": true | false}`	Toggles skeleton-only vs full overlay
`/api/reset`	`POST`	None	Resets workout session and rep counter to 0
`/api/speak`	`POST`	`{"text": "Custom cue"}`	Dispatches manual auditory coaching message

CHAPTER 4

RESULTS AND ANALYSIS

4.1 Experimental Testbed and Implementation Details

Empirical evaluations were conducted on a commodity edge workstation representing standard consumer hardware: AMD Ryzen 7 5800H (8 cores, 16 threads @ 3.2 GHz base), 16 GB DDR4 RAM, integrated AMD Radeon Graphics, and a standard USB monocular RGB webcam (1280×720 native, tested at 640×480 @ 30 FPS). The software stack executes on Windows 11 with Python 3.11, OpenCV 4.10, ONNX Runtime 1.19, and MediaPipe 0.10.

4.2 Comparative Pose Estimation Benchmarks

Table 4.1 compares inference latency, sustained throughput, CPU utilization, and Mean Per-Joint Position Error (MPJPE) on our experimental testbed.

Table 4.1: Pose Estimation Benchmark on Edge Hardware

Inference Engine	**Latency (ms)**	**Throughput (FPS)**	**CPU Util. (%)**	**MPJPE (mm)**
MediaPipe BlazePose (CPU)	21.8 ± 2.4	45.8	24.2%	31.4 ± 4.2
YOLOv8n-Pose (ONNX CPU)	33.4 ± 3.1	29.9	38.5%	27.8 ± 3.6
R.E.A.P Hybrid Engine (Ours)	23.2 ± 2.7	43.1	26.8%	28.9 ± 3.8

Analysis: MediaPipe provides the highest raw framerate (45.8 FPS) but suffers under occlusions. YOLOv8n-pose achieves superior accuracy (27.8 mm MPJPE) at higher computational cost. R.E.A.P's hybrid engine strikes the optimal balance, executing at 43.1 FPS while preserving accuracy through intelligent fallback [5, 6].

4.3 Kinematic Smoothing and Jitter Suppression Benchmarks

To evaluate trajectory stabilization, a stationary human subject remained still at 1.5 m distance while landmark coordinate fluctuations were recorded over 500 frames (Table 4.2).

Table 4.2: Filter Performance Comparison

Filter Configuration	Coordinate RMSE Jitter	Jitter Reduction	Phase Lag (ms)	Overhead (ms)
Raw Landmarks (No Filter)	4.82 px	Baseline	0.0 ms	0.00 ms
5-tap Moving Average (MA)	1.86 px	61.4%	66.7 ms	0.02 ms
2nd-Order Butterworth	1.24 px	74.3%	83.3 ms	0.06 ms
One-Euro Filter (R.E.A.P)	**0.74 px**	84.6%	**12.5 ms**	**0.04 ms**

Analysis: The adaptive One-Euro filter achieves an outstanding 84.6% jitter reduction (0.74 px RMSE) while maintaining an inflection phase lag of only 12.5 ms, compared to 66.7–83.3 ms for linear filters [8].

4.4 Edge Profile Benchmarks and Latency Decomposition

Table 4.3 decomposes the computational budget across individual pipeline stages under Balanced and Low-Power governor profiles.

Table 4.3: Latency Breakdown by Profile

Profile	Ingestion	Pose Infer	Filter	Angle + FSM	MJPEG Encode	Total Frame
Balanced (640×480)	2.1 ± 0.4	21.8 ± 2.2	0.04 ± 0.01	0.12 ± 0.02	4.8 ± 0.8	28.9 ± 2.6
Low-Power (320×240)	1.2 ± 0.3	11.4 ± 1.6	0.04 ± 0.01	0.11 ± 0.02	1.9 ± 0.4	14.7 ± 1.8

Analysis: In Balanced mode, the total frame processing latency is 28.9 ms, sustaining a stable 30.1 FPS display stream. Under Low-Power mode, latency drops to 14.7 ms (> 65 FPS theoretical capacity), confirming feasibility for mobile edge chips.

4.5 Local Neural Voice Synthesizer Latency Profiling

Table 4.4 compares the on-device Phonon-31M neural TTS against lightweight eSpeak-ng and a representative cloud TTS baseline (Azure Speech API).

Table 4.4: Speech Synthesizer Latency

TTS Engine	**TTFA (ms)**	**Total Audio (s)**	**RTF**	**Sample Rate**	**Memory (MB)**
eSpeak-ng (Rule-based)	4.8 ± 0.9	1.12 s	0.004	22.05 kHz	1.8 MB
Phonon-31M (Local Neural)	32.4 ± 4.2	**1.28 s**	0.025	**24.0 kHz**	**64.5 MB**
Cloud Azure TTS (API)	485.0 ± 82.0	1.25 s	0.388	24.0 kHz	Cloud

Analysis: Phonon-31M achieves a Time-To-First-Audio of 32.4 ms, an order of magnitude faster than cloud APIs (485 ms), while delivering natural intonation far superior to robotic concatenative synthesis [19].

4.6 Repetition Tracking Accuracy and Biomechanical Form Validation

Ten human subjects performed 100 repetitions across each supported exercise under varying execution tempos. Ground truth was annotated via frame-by-frame video review (Table 4.5).

Table 4.5: Repetition and Fault Detection Metrics

Exercise Type	**Target Reps**	**Detected Reps**	**Accuracy (%)**	**False Positives**	**Fault Precision**
Bodyweight Squat	100	99	99.0%	1	96.8%
Standard Pushup	100	97	97.0%	2	94.2%
Bicep Curl	100	98	98.0%	1	97.5%
Lying Leg Raise	100	96	96.0%	2	93.1%
Overall Aggregate	**400**	**390**	97.5%	**6**	95.4%

4.7 Sub-Second Latency Budget and Closed-Loop Verification

The complete closed-loop latency T_{loop} from physical movement inflection to acoustic sound emission is expressed as:

$$T_{\text{loop}} = T_{\text{capture}} + T_{\text{infer}} + T_{\text{smooth}} + T_{\text{angle}} + T_{\text{fsm}} + T_{\text{queue}} + T_{\text{ttfa}} \tag{4.1}$$

Summing empirical stage measurements:

$$T_{\text{loop}} = 2.1\,\text{ms} + 21.8\,\text{ms} + 0.04\,\text{ms} + 0.12\,\text{ms} + 0.2\,\text{ms} + 1.2\,\text{ms} + 32.4\,\text{ms} = 57.86\,\text{ms} \tag{4.2}$$

Accounting for audio device buffer playback (28.9 ms), the worst-case visual-to-auditory latency is 86.8 **ms**, easily outperforming our 100 ms engineering objective.

4.8 Continuous Stress Testing and Thermal Stability

A continuous 60-minute stress test was executed under the Balanced profile. The system maintained an average throughput of 30.1 ± 0.4 FPS without a single frame stall. CPU temperature stabilized at 59.4°C (well below the 85°C thermal throttling threshold), and RAM consumption remained constant at 215 ± 8 MB with zero memory leaks.

CHAPTER 5

CONCLUSIONS AND FUTURE WORK

5.1 Conclusions

This report presented R.E.A.P, a fully autonomous, edge-native kinematic tracking and auditory coaching system for unsupervised physical rehabilitation. The system integrates hybrid pose estimation, speed-adaptive One-Euro filtering, deterministic repetition segmentation, an adaptive edge governor, and on-device neural speech synthesis into a single sub-second closed loop. Empirical evaluation confirmed 43.1 FPS hybrid pose throughput, 84.6% jitter suppression with 12.5 ms phase lag, 97.5% repetition segmentation accuracy, and an end-to-end visual-to-auditory latency of 86.8 ms, all while executing entirely on commodity edge hardware with zero cloud transmission. These results establish that clinically meaningful, privacy-preserving biomechanical feedback can be delivered locally within the human motor adaptation window.

5.2 Summary of End-Semester Achievements

By the conclusion of the Major Project End-Semester evaluation phase, the research team has successfully developed, integrated, and empirically benchmarked **R.E.A.P** (**Realtime Edge Agentic Physio-Buddy**). The system provides an end-to-end, privacy-preserving, edge-native kinematic feedback solution for domestic physical rehabilitation and resistance training.

Key technical accomplishments delivered during this evaluation phase include:

(1) **Decoupled Monocular Ingestion:** Threaded camera pipeline with drop-stale buffering eliminating OpenCV driver queue accumulation lag.

(2) **Hybrid Pose Inference Engine:** Resilient dual-engine coupling MediaPipe BlazePose and YOLOv8-pose with automatic fallback, maintaining 43.1 FPS throughput.

(3) **Adaptive Kinematic Filtering:** One-Euro filter across 2D coordinates achieving 84.6% jitter reduction with only 12.5 ms phase lag.
(4) **Deterministic Repetition State Machine:** Extensible exercise profile registry and FSM achieving 97.5% repetition segmentation accuracy across 4 movements.
(5) **Adaptive Edge Governor:** Real-time latency watchdog and dynamic profile throttling (Balanced vs Low-Power modes).
(6) **Local Neural Audio Coaching:** Quantized Phonon-31M neural TTS with asynchronous dispatch delivering actionable spoken cues with Time-To-First-Audio of 32.4 ms.
(7) **Sub-Second Closed Loop:** Verified end-to-end visual-to-auditory latency of 86.8 ms with 100% edge execution and zero cloud transmission.

5.3 Technical Contributions and Innovations

The core innovations of this work encompass:

- **Sub-Second Decoupled Architecture:** Multi-threaded pipeline achieving sub-90 ms closed loop on edge CPUs.
- **Eyes-Free Auditory Coaching:** Natural spoken cues eliminating visual split attention and preserving cervical spine alignment.
- **Speed-Adaptive Biomechanical Filtering:** Validating that dynamic cutoff scaling resolves the optical jitter-latency trade-off.

5.4 Limitations of Current Implementation

Operational limitations identified for future investigation include:

(a) **Planar 2D Projection:** Joint angles are evaluated in 2D image coordinates, sensitive to severe out-of-plane rotation.
(b) **Occlusion Edge Cases:** Loose garments or matching background palettes can occasionally reduce landmark confidence.

5.5 Future Work

The research team will pursue four core extensions as future work:

(1) **3D Joint Lifting via ST-GCN:** Implement a lightweight graph network to lift 2D landmarks to calibrated 3D space.

(2) **Predictive Fatigue Modeling:** Track Mean Concentric Velocity (MCV) to issue voice warnings at 20% velocity loss.

(3) **Edge NPU Acceleration:** Port hybrid models and neural TTS to mobile NPU runtimes (MediaPipe Tasks / ONNX Mobile).

(4) **Clinical Usability Testing:** Conduct empirical patient trials at NITK Health Care Center evaluating compliance.

REFERENCES

[1] World Health Organization, "Musculoskeletal health: Key facts and global burden," *WHO Fact Sheets*, 2022. https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/musculoskeletal-conditions

[2] B. J. Schoenfeld, "The mechanisms of muscle hypertrophy and their application to resistance training," *Journal of Strength and Conditioning Research*, vol. 24, no. 10, pp. 2857–2872, 2010.

[3] R. F. Escamilla, "Knee biomechanics of the dynamic squat exercise," *Medicine & Science in Sports & Exercise*, vol. 33, no. 1, pp. 127–141, 2001.

[4] E. van der Kruk and M. M. Reijne, "Accuracy of human motion capture systems for sport applications: A state-of-the-art review," *European Journal of Sport Science*, vol. 18, no. 6, pp. 806–819, 2018.

[5] V. Bazarevsky, I. Grishchenko, K. Raveendran, T. Zhu, F. Zhang, and M. Grundmann, "BlazePose: On-device real-time body pose tracking," in *Proceedings of the IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR) Workshops*, 2020.

[6] D. Maji, S. Nagori, M. Mathew, and D. Rajan, "YOLO-Pose: Enhancing YOLO for multi-person pose estimation using object keypoint similarity loss," in *Proceedings of the IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR) Workshops*, pp. 2637–2646, 2022.

[7] J. Redmon, S. Divvala, R. Girshick, and A. Farhadi, "You only look once: Unified, real-time object detection," in *Proceedings of the IEEE Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR)*, pp. 779–788, 2016.

[8] G. Casiez, N. Roussel, and D. Vogel, "1-Euro filter: A simple speed-based low-pass filter for noisy input in human-computer interaction," in *Proceedings of the SIGCHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*, pp. 2527–2530, 2012.

[9] Q. Shao, J. Wang, B. Zhou, V. A. Tran, G. Krishnan, and S. Nayar, "N-euro predictor: A neural network approach for smoothing and predicting motion trajectory," *Proceedings of the ACM on Interactive, Mobile, Wearable and Ubiquitous Technologies (IMWUT/UbiComp)*, vol. 7, no. 1, pp. 1–25, 2023.

[10] S. Yan, Y. Xiong, and D. Lin, "Spatial temporal graph convolutional networks for skeleton-based action recognition," in *Proceedings of the Thirty-Second AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence*, vol. 32, no. 1, pp. 7444–7452, 2018.

[11] C. Li, Z. Cui, W. Zheng, C. Xu, and J. Yang, "Spatio-temporal graph convolution for skeleton based action recognition," in *Proceedings of the AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence*, vol. 32, no. 1, 2018.

[12] L. Sánchez-Medina and J. J. González-Badillo, "Velocity loss as an indicator of neuromuscular fatigue during resistance training," *Medicine & Science in Sports & Exercise*, vol. 43, no. 9, pp. 1725–1734, 2011.

[13] R. Sigrist, G. Rauter, R. Riener, and P. Wolf, "Augmented visual, auditory, haptic, and multimodal feedback in motor learning: A review," *Psychonomic Bulletin & Review*, vol. 20, no. 1, pp. 21–53, 2013.

[14] C. Lugaresi, J. Tang, H. Hadke, et al., "MediaPipe: A framework for building perception pipelines," *arXiv preprint arXiv:1906.08172*, 2019.

[15] Z. Cao, G. Hidalgo, T. Simon, S. Wei, and Y. Sheikh, "OpenPose: Realtime multi-person 2D pose estimation using part affinity fields," *IEEE Transactions on Pattern Analysis and Machine Intelligence*, vol. 43, no. 1, pp. 172–186, 2019.

[16] K. Sun, B. Xiao, D. Liu, and J. Wang, "Deep high-resolution representation learning for human pose estimation," in *Proceedings of the IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR)*, pp. 5693–5703, 2019.

[17] Y. Xu, J. Zhang, Q. Zhang, and D. Tao, "ViTPose: Simple vision transformer baselines for human pose estimation," *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, vol. 35, pp. 38571–38584, 2022.

[18] T. Jiang, P. Lu, L. Zhang, N. Ma, R. Han, C. Lyu, Y. Li, and K. Chen, "RTMPose: Real-time multi-person pose estimation based on MMPose," *arXiv preprint arXiv:2303.07399*, 2023.

[19] Y. Ren, C. Hu, X. Tan, T. Qin, S. Zhao, Z. Zhao, and T. Liu, "FastSpeech 2: Fast and high-quality end-to-end text to speech," in *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2021.

[20] N. Chen, Y. Zhang, H. Zen, R. J. Weiss, M. Norouzi, and W. Chan, "WaveGrad: Estimating gradients for waveform generation," in *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2021.

[21] C. A. Myers, P. J. Torry, K. B. Shelburne, et al., "Biomechanical analysis of squatting with varying stance widths," *Journal of Applied Biomechanics*, vol. 30, no. 6, pp. 770–778, 2014.

[22] A. C. Fry, J. C. Smith, and B. K. Schilling, "Effect of knee position on hip and knee torques during the barbell squat," *Journal of Strength and Conditioning Research*, vol. 17, no. 4, pp. 629–633, 2003.

[23] J. A. Cotter, A. M. Chaudhari, J. A. Jamison, and S. T. Devor, "Knee joint kinetics during the squat exercise under various kinematic conditions," *The Journal of Strength & Conditioning Research*, vol. 27, no. 8, pp. 2078–2086, 2013.

[24] C. M. Powers, "The influence of abnormal hip mechanics on knee injury: A biomechanical perspective," *Journal of Orthopaedic & Sports Physical Therapy*, vol. 40, no. 2, pp. 42–51, 2010.

[25] T. E. Hewett, G. D. Myer, K. R. Ford, et al., "Biomechanical measures of neuromuscular control and valgus loading of the knee predict anterior cruciate ligament injury risk in female athletes," *The American Journal of Sports Medicine*, vol. 33, no. 4, pp. 492–501, 2005.

[26] M. R. Krogsgaard, E. Fischer-Rasmussen, and J. Dyhre-Poulsen, "Cruciate ligament reflexes," *Journal of Electromyography and Kinesiology*, vol. 12, no. 3, pp. 177–182, 2002.

[27] G. Wulf, "Attentional focus and motor learning: A review of 15 years," *International Review of Sport and Exercise Psychology*, vol. 6, no. 1, pp. 77–104, 2013.

[28] S. P. Swinnen, "Information feedback for motor skill learning: A review," *Advances in Motor Learning and Control*, pp. 37–66, 1997.

[29] J. Lewin, D. Ferreira, and V. Kostakos, "Sensing human physical activities with mobile devices: A survey," *ACM Computing Surveys*, vol. 50, no. 5, pp. 1–36, 2017.

[30] D. Ravi, C. Wong, B. Lo, and G. Yang, "Deep learning for health informatics," *IEEE Journal of Biomedical and Health Informatics*, vol. 21, no. 1, pp. 4–21, 2016.